Hope Trade Holds

S&P +2.92% as Trump signals willingness to end Iran war. Nasdaq +3.83%. Tech leads broad rally. WTI pulls back to $101. Q1 closes down ~7%.

THE SESSION

The hope trade that opened and closed in a single session on Monday held all day Tuesday. Reports that President Trump told aides he would consider ending the Iran war—even without the Strait of Hormuz fully reopened—ignited a broad rally that gained momentum into the close. The S&P 500 surged 2.92% to 6,528.65, its strongest session since May. The Nasdaq led at +3.83%, the Dow added 1,025 points (+2.49%), and the Russell 2000 gained 3.41%. Of 500 constituents, 441 finished higher. Ten of eleven sectors advanced; energy was the sole decliner as WTI pulled back to $101.38, down 1.5% on the session.

The VIX collapsed 17.2% to 25.35—still elevated, but a meaningful retreat from the 31+ levels seen last Friday. Treasuries extended their advance as yields fell, providing additional support for equity valuations. The dollar weakened and gold surged 3.3% to $4,710, as safe-haven flows and risk appetite coexisted in a market pricing both de-escalation optimism and lingering inflation uncertainty. Defense Secretary Hegseth noted Iran launched fewer projectiles in the past 24 hours than at any point during the conflict, reinforcing the narrative that the operational tempo is declining.

Consumer confidence edged higher to 91.8 in March, topping the consensus estimate of 87.5 and offering a modest positive amid the prevailing pessimism. The present situation index improved 4.6 points to 123.3. However, the expectations index slipped to 70.9—remaining below the 80 threshold that has historically signaled recession. JOLTS data showed job openings and hirings both declining in February, consistent with a cooling but not collapsing labor market.

Q1 officially closes with the S&P 500 down approximately 7% year-to-date—the weakest first quarter since 2022. The Nasdaq remains in correction territory. Today's rally does not erase the structural damage of five consecutive losing weeks, but it does suggest that the selling pressure that dominated March has a ceiling when even modest de-escalation signals emerge.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P 500 at 6,529 remains well above the −20% drawdown threshold that would trigger the first buy tranche. The portfolio holds its positioning. Today's rally confirms the thesis: oversold conditions resolve sharply when the catalyst arrives. The discipline is being in position before it does.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

SUPV +12.00% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Argentine bank rallied sharply on the broad risk-on bid. Emerging market financials benefited disproportionately as de-escalation hopes improved global risk appetite.

HUT +9.81% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin mining operations gained alongside crypto. BTC rose 1.8% to $67,926, and miners amplified the move with higher beta exposure to digital asset sentiment.

COIN +8.60% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Crypto exchange led fintech higher as Bitcoin stabilized and risk appetite returned. Trading volumes likely benefited from the volatility cycle.

GFI +7.33% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miners surged as gold gained 3.3% to $4,710. The VanEck Gold Miners ETF rose over 4% on the session. Gold and equity strength coexisted as the market priced both de-escalation and persistent inflation.

LRCX +6.87% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Semiconductor equipment rallied as Nvidia's $2 billion investment in Marvell lifted the entire chip supply chain. Tech rotation drove broad-based semi strength.

DECLINERS

CNX –3.58% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Natural gas producer gave back gains as de-escalation hopes reduced the energy war premium. CNX had been a consistent beneficiary of the conflict's supply disruption.

OKE –2.76% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Midstream energy declined alongside the broader energy complex. Pipeline operators are direct beneficiaries of elevated throughput pricing that would compress in a ceasefire scenario.

CVX –1.81% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Integrated oil pulled back as WTI retreated to $101. CVX had been among the portfolio's strongest performers throughout March on the energy supply shock.

VLO –1.27% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Refiner declined modestly as crack spreads narrowed on the de-escalation bid. VLO remains up significantly for March and Q1 on the broader energy dislocation.

ADP –1.11% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Payroll processor lagged as the market rotated into higher-beta growth and tech names. Defensive positioning took a backseat on the risk-on session.

HOLDINGS NEWS

NVDA +5.59% (Growth Portfolio). Nvidia announced a $2 billion investment in Marvell Technology, expanding its AI ecosystem through the NVLink Fusion platform. The partnership integrates Marvell's custom XPUs and networking solutions into Nvidia's infrastructure stack. This is Nvidia's latest in a series of $2 billion ecosystem investments following similar deals with Synopsys, CoreWeave, Coherent, and Lumentum. The deal lifted the broader semiconductor complex, benefiting LRCX, TSM, NXPI, and ADI across both IOWN sleeves.

NXPI +5.05% (Growth Portfolio). NXP Semiconductors gained on the tech rally and continued attention to its March 16 announcement of robotics solutions developed in collaboration with Nvidia. The partnership combines Nvidia's Holoscan Sensor Bridge with NXP's SoCs for sensor fusion, machine vision, and motor control in humanoid robotics applications.

SYF +3.04% (Growth Portfolio). Synchrony Financial rose despite Truist lowering its price target to $71 from a prior level. The broader financials rally on de-escalation sentiment outweighed the analyst action.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

+1.64%

vs. DVY +0.92% | IWS +2.43%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

+3.68%

vs. IUSG +4.03%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +5.09% vs DVY +7.29% / IWS +2.36%
Growth –2.46% vs IUSG –8.33%